2026 Methodology Updates Overview

Corporate Sustainability Assessment (CSA)

March 2026

S&P Global

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1 Continuous development of the CSA

2 Updates in the CSA structure

3 Governance & Economic Dimension

4 Environmental Dimension

5 Social Dimension

Agenda

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1

Continuous development of the CSA

- Leveraging sustainability intelligence to evaluate corporate performance on and management of ESG risks, opportunities and impact
- Ensuring alignment with materiality analysis
- Evolving the CSA to align with changing reporting landscape

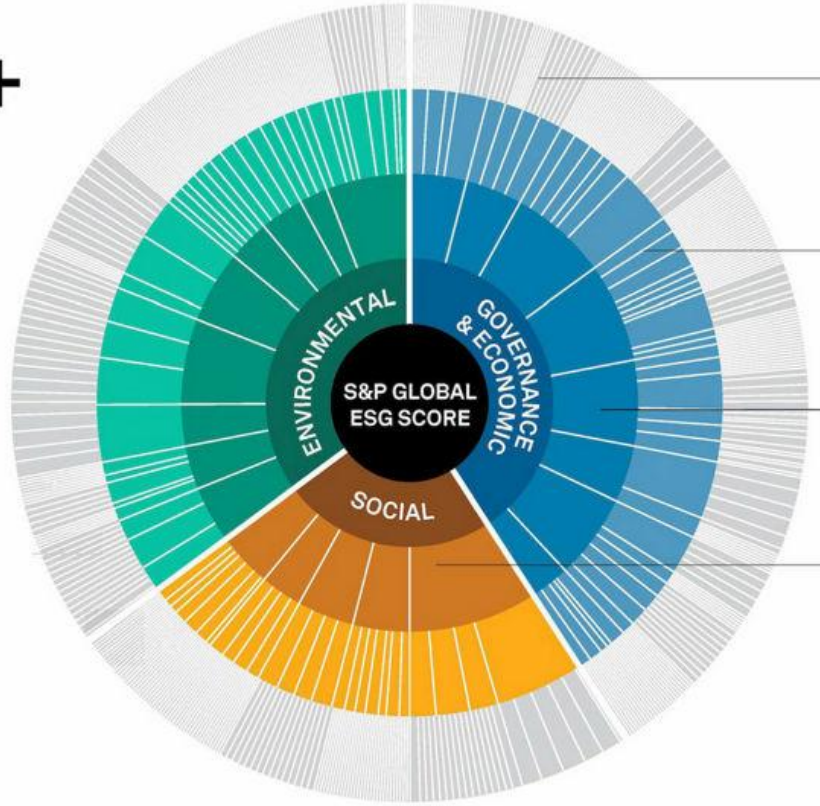
1 Scoring Structure: Multiple layers of Insight
Global Coverage and deep insights and data

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The S&P Global ESG Score measures a company's performance on and management of material ESG risk, opportunities and impacts.

13,000+
Companies

99%
Global market capitalization



Approx.
1,000
Data points
Assessed values, text, checkboxes, documents
Sources: Web-based questionnaire and company documents

Up to
100 +
Question-level scores
Weighted data point scores
Up to 50% industry-specific
Includes question-level scores based on modeling approaches in the absence of disclosure

Up to
30 +
Criteria scores
Weighted question scores
62 industry-specific approaches, with tailored questions, criteria and related weightings

3
Dimension scores
Weighted criteria scores
Adjusted for corporate ESG controversies where applicable

1 S&P Global ESG Score
Sum of weighted dimension scores

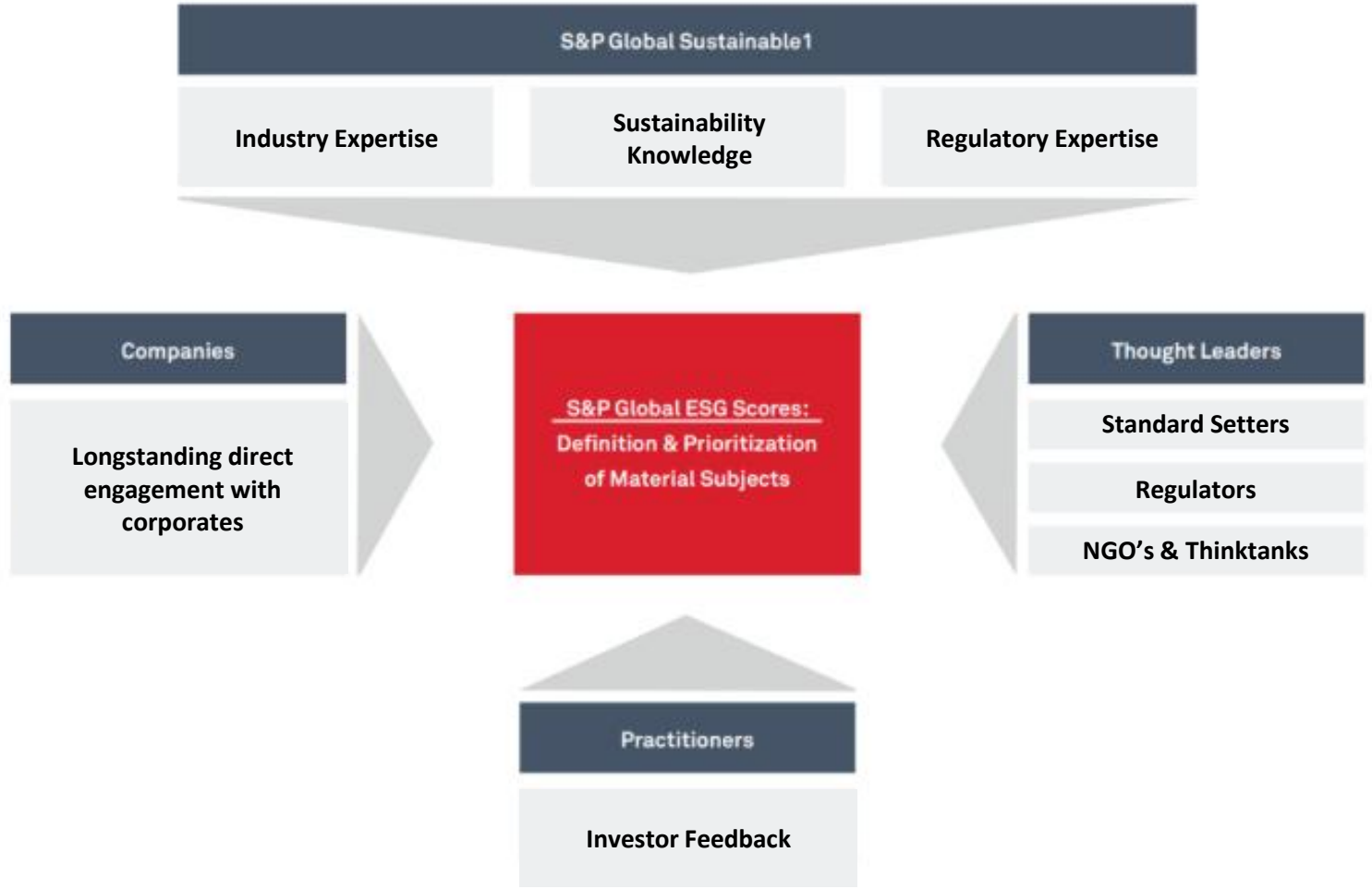
Source: S&P Global CSA 2023. For illustrative purposes only

1 Continuous development of the CSA

Leveraging sustainability insights to generate long-term investment returns

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The CSA continuously evolves on an annual basis to ensure it reflects the latest development in the market.



1 Scoring Structure: Multiple layers of Insight

Global Coverage and deep insights and data

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22 Materiality Core Subjects mapped to 40+ criteria topics, cross-sectoral & industry specific, linked with key risks, opportunities, and impacts

Governance & economic

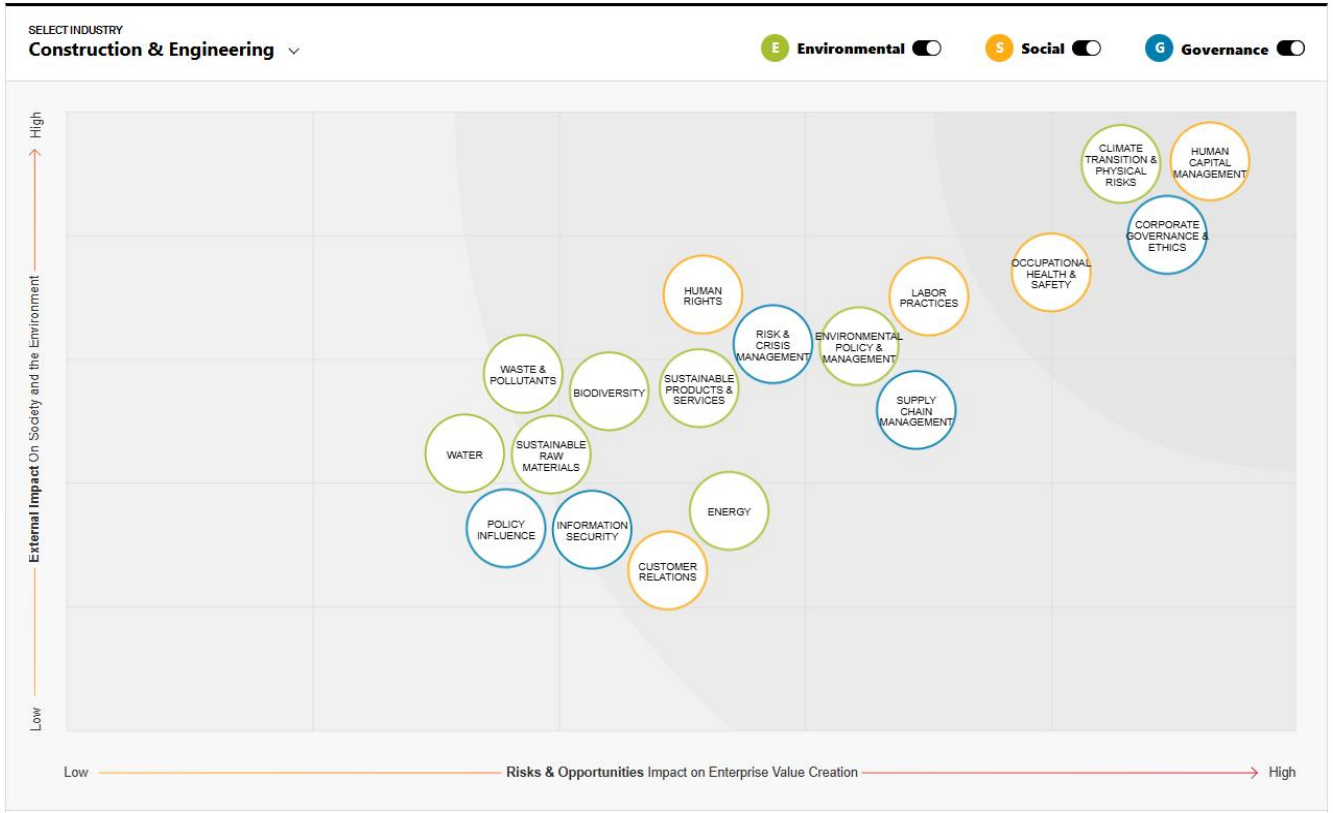
- Corporate governance & ethics
- Information security
- Policy influence
- Risk & crisis management
- Supply chain management
- Tax strategy

Environmental

- Biodiversity
- Climate transition & physical risks
- Energy
- Environmental policy & management
- Sustainable products & services
- Sustainable raw materials
- Waste & pollutants
- Water

Social

- Customer relations
- Human capital management
- Human rights
- Labor practices
- Occupational health & safety
- Privacy protection
- Product/service quality & safety
- Society & community relations



Source: S&P Global ESG Scores: Materiality in Industry Context ESG Scores
https://www.spglobal.com/sustainable1/en/solutions/dataset-tools/industry-materiality

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2

Updates on CSA Structure

- Question deletions and consolidation
- Evolution of requirements on public disclosure

2 Updates in the CSA structure
Question deletions

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4 questions deleted
Governance & Economic

Transparency & Reporting
→ **Sustainability Taxonomies**

Supply Chain Management
→ **KPIs for Supplier Screening**

Innovation Management
→ **Product Innovations (Healthcare)**
→ **Healthcare Clinical Pipeline**

3 questions deleted
Environmental

Water
→ **Business Impacts of Water Related Incidents**

Climate Strategy
→ **Financial Opportunities Arising from Climate Change**

Decarbonization Strategy
→ **Scope 3 Financed Emission Intensity**

4 questions deleted
Social

Contribution to Societal Healthcare
→ **Contribution to Increasing Healthcare Efficiency**
→ **Measure Contribution to Health Outcome**
→ **Patent Filing Policy**

Customer Relations
→ **Brand Management Metrics**

2 Updates in the CSA structure
Evolution of requirements on public disclosure

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- ***"Private" question:*** *Question in which publicly available evidence is not necessary and private evidence is acceptable. No impact in the score if the evidence is not public.*
- ***"Partially public" question:*** *Question in which publicly available evidence is not mandatory but is necessary to obtain full points. Private evidences are acceptable, but do not grant full points.*
- ***"Public" question:*** *Question in which publicly available evidence is mandatory. If information is not publicly available, it is not accepted.*

2 questions transitioning
From Private to Partially Public

Sustainable Forestry Practices
→ **Small Forest Owners**

Sustainable Raw Materials
→ **Share of Organic Products**

2 questions transitioning
From Partially Public to Public

Supply Chain Management
→ **Conflict Minerals Due Diligence Process**

Innovation Management
→ **Tobacco Alternatives & Reduced-Risk Products**

1 question transitioning
From Private to Public

Responsible Artificial Intelligence
→ **Responsible Artificial Intelligence Policy**

1 question transitioning
From Public to Partially public

Climate Strategy
→ **Climate-Related Management Incentives**

* Special note regarding public disclosure → **Starting in 2026 CSA Cycle, and due to changes in CDP's accessibility policies, the information contained in CDP reports that are not accessible in company's website will no longer be considered publicly available information**

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3

Changes in questions: Governance and Economic

- Responsible Artificial Intelligence
- Product Quality and Recalls
- Supply Chain Management

3 Changes in questions
Governance and economic – Responsible Artificial Intelligence

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Key Changes

- The Sustainable Artificial Intelligence criterion, now referred to as “Responsible Artificial Intelligence”, has been moved from the Future Questions section to the CSA questionnaire.
- The “Artificial Intelligence Policy” question, now referred to as “Responsible Artificial Intelligence Policy” has evolved to reflect additional policy aspects. The information is now required to be reported in the public domain.
- The “Artificial Intelligence and ESG Performance” question has been replaced with a newly designed question, “Responsible Artificial Intelligence Program” which focuses on the implementation of measures that ensure the responsible use of artificial intelligence (AI) within an organization. The information is required to be reported in the public domain.
- A new question on “Artificial Intelligence KPIs” question was proposed, focusing on key performance indicators linked to the use and deployment of AI systems, such as investment volume and the revenue/cost impacts of AI initiatives. This question will not be included in the CSA 2026

Feedback from public consultation

- Topic is significant and question guidance is clear.
- While the information on Policy and Programs is expected to be in the public domain, stakeholders expressed concerns on the availability of the information on KPIs (public or private) and therefore the question will not be included in the CSA as of now.

Industries Impacted

ALL

3 Changes in questions
Governance and economic – Product Quality & Recalls

Sustainable1

Key Changes

The question “Product Quality Programs” has undergone a major update to provide more specific insights into company practices.

It now includes five new aspects that assess whether companies are integrating emerging technologies to enhance product quality, setting quantitative targets to improve product quality performance and requiring supplier adherence to their product and service quality standards.

Additionally, we seek to understand whether companies disclose descriptions and root causes of product quality incidents, aligning with SASB standards applicable to the relevant industries. Detailed guidance on each aspect is available in the dedicated question guidance section.

Feedback from public consultation

- Topic is significant, information is available, and question guidance is clear.

Industries Impacted

ARO
ATX
AUT
BLD
BTC
COS
DHP
DRG
ELQ
FDR
FOA
HOU
IEQ
LEG
LIF
MTC
RTS
SEM

3 Changes in questions
Governance and economic – Supply Chain

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Key Changes

- The question “KPIs for Supplier Screening” will be deleted.
- The question “KPIs for Supplier Assessment and Development” has undergone a major update. Some existing data points from two questions, “KPIs for Supplier Screening” and “KPIs for Supplier Assessment and Development,” are carried over and modified to the updated layout.
- The question regarding “Conflict Minerals” has been updated and split into two separate questions: one focusing on conflict minerals due diligence and the other on key performance indicators. The original question will be renamed “Conflict Minerals Due Diligence Process”. Some data points from the original “Conflict Minerals” question will be retained. The question will require all information to be publicly disclosed.
- A new question, “Conflict Minerals Indicators,” was created. This incorporates the existing two quantitative data points concerning revenues from products containing minerals sourced from conflict-affected and high-risk areas. The requirements for these data points remain unchanged, but it is applied to two new industries: Life Science Tool & services and Health care Equipment & Supplies; additional points will be awarded for public reporting.

Feedback from public consultation

- Topic is significant, information is available and question guidance is clear.

Industries Impacted

ALL except

BNK

CSV

FBN

IMS

INS

PRO

SOF

TSV

Agenda

Sustainable1

4

Changes in questions: Environmental

- Climate Strategy
- Packaging
- Product Stewardship
- Sustainable Raw Materials

4 Changes in questions
Environmental – Climate Strategy

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Key Changes

- A new question “Net-Zero Transition Plan” has been introduced to assess the robustness and credibility of a company’s transition plan for aligning its business activities with the Paris Agreement goal of limiting global warming to 1.5°C, or the latest climate science.
- While several elements of a climate transition plan (such as climate governance, risk management, emission inventory and reduction targets) are already included in other questions of the criterion, the new question focuses on the strategic ambition, finance, decarbonization levers and engagement strategy that are expected to be part of a separate transition plan document or a dedicated section in the annual reporting.
- The part focusing on key actions or decarbonization levers that will drive progress towards meeting the company’s emission reduction targets has been moved from the question Net-Zero Commitment (which applies to all industries except financial sector) to the Transition Plan question.
- In addition, the question “Financial Opportunities Arising from Climate Change” has been deleted due to the partial overlap with the Sustainable Revenues question.

Industries Impacted

ALL except

BNK

FBN

INS

Feedback from public consultation

- Topic is significant and information is available.
- However further clarification was needed about the purpose of the question on measuring transition plans towards net zero commitments exclusively

4 Changes in questions
Environmental – Packaging

Sustainable1

Key Changes

- The “Packaging Materials” question has been updated to differentiate the datapoints of the share of packaging materials coming from certified and recycled sources.
- The share of material that is certified is only requested for wood & paper packaging, along with disclosing the certification standard name. The share of material that comes from recycled sources is requested for all three materials: wood & paper, metal, and glass packaging.
- The question will no longer include the data points of coverage (% of cost of goods sold) and target for each material. Additional credit will be granted for public reporting of the KPI’s for each packaging material separately.

Industries Impacted

AIR
BVG
CNO
COS
FDR
FOA
HOU
REX
RTS
TEX
TOB
TRT

Feedback from public consultation

- Topic is significant, information is available, and question guidance is clear.

4 Changes in questions
Environmental – Product Stewardship

Sustainable1

Key Changes

- A new question on “Sustainable Products Program” is introduced to address companies’ actions towards a sustainable portfolio of products and services regardless on whether the company operates in a manufacturing industry or not.
- The question “Share of Organic Products” has been moved from Sustainable Raw Materials to the Product Stewardship criterion. It has also been updated to a tabular form, asking for multiple years of data and to include the opportunity to report on other sustainable revenues. This is aligned with other sustainable revenue questions.
- The scope of the questions, “Circular fashion commitment”, “Circular fashion programs”, and “Circular fashion indicators”, has been expanded to include the Retailing industry, with a particular emphasis on apparel retailers. Additionally, “Circular fashion indicators” underwent a minor layout update to streamline reporting and improve simplicity.

Industries Impacted

ALL except
BNK
BTC
BVG
DRG
FBN
FOA
HEA
INS
LIF
MTC
TOB

Feedback from public consultation

- Topic is significant, information is available, and question guidance is clear.

4 Changes in questions
Environmental – Sustainable Raw Materials

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Key Changes

- The existing “Raw Materials Policy” question is applied to two new industries: Paper & Forest Products and Containers and Packaging, while the “Raw Materials Programs” question is applied to one new industry: Containers and Packaging.
- The following questions had a refreshed layout to simplify and align with others in the criterion: “Certifications of Agricultural Crops”, “Certifications of Animal Products”, “Plant & Animal-Derived Textile Materials”, “Plastic Raw Materials”, “Metal Raw Materials”, and “Recycled Building Materials”.
- The “Use of Recycled & Sustainably Sourced Materials” question was moved from the Product Stewardship criterion to Sustainable Raw Materials. The layout was optimized and certified material was removed, so only recycled material must be reported.
- The Sustainable Forestry Practices criterion was deleted, and its questions moved to Sustainable Raw Materials. The “Forest Management Certification” question and “Chain of Custody Certification” have undergone major updates. Both have added new quantitative metrics on wood-based material production and purchase, as well as minor changes to align with other questions in this criterion.
- The “Small Forest Owners” has been updated to get more specific insights into programs implemented by companies if they purchase wood from smallholders or small forest owners.

Feedback from public consultation

- Topic is significant, information is available and question guidance is clear.

Industries Impacted

ARO
ATX
AUT
CON
CMT
CTR
ELQ
FDR
FOA
FRP
IEQ
ITC
SEM
TEX
THQ
TOB
RTS

Agenda

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5

Changes in questions: Social

- Customer Relations
- Contribution to Societal Healthcare

5 Changes in questions
Social – Customer Relations

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Key Changes

- A new question “Customer Relations Management” has been introduced to better assess the mechanisms companies have in place to effectively manage customer interactions, feedback and complaints. The question includes aspects such as ensuring multiple communication channels to cater different customer preferences, processes to incorporate feedback into product and service development and implementing a transparent and consumer-friendly complaints process.
- Additionally, the question “Brand Management Metrics” has been deleted due to the lack of standardized metrics and public reporting.

Feedback from public consultation

- Topic is significant, information is available, and question guidance is clear.

Industries Impacted

ALL except
ARO
ATX
BTC
COL
DRG
HEA
HOM
LIF
MNX
MTC
OGR
OGX
REI
REM

5 Changes in questions
Social – Contribution to Societal Healthcare

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Key Changes

- The “Access to Healthcare Programs (Products & Drugs)” and “Access to Healthcare Programs” questions have been updated to remove the open text box of other programs, and to instead include acceptable relevant programs towards access for the given industries.
- The question “Partnerships for Access to Healthcare” has been updated to add further acceptable partnerships for advancement towards access to healthcare.
- The question “Local Capacity Building” has had an update to the layout, to avoid double counting of topics and to ensure the question fully captures the different program topics.
- Lastly, the three questions regarding "Patent Filing Policy", "Measure Contribution to Health Outcome" and "Contribution to Increasing Healthcare Efficiency" have been removed due to the absence of standardized metrics and public reporting. The topic of patent filing will be incorporated into the “Access to Healthcare Programs (Products & Drugs)” question, as it is a material topic to the applicable industries. Additionally, the qualitative aspects of healthcare efficiency will be addressed within the “Accessibility & Transparency of Research” section to ensure comprehensive evaluation.

Industries Impacted

BTC

DRG

HEA

MTC

Feedback from public consultation

- Topic is significant, information is available, and question guidance is clear.

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